Horicon Bank Portal

Stakeholder Interviews

Validation Sprint • 30-minute conversations gathering frontline perspective

Interview Overview

Scheduled 30-minute conversations to gather additional perspective across data analytics, operations, customer relations, and marketing. These interviews provide ground truth on persona usage, market reality, and implementation challenges to validate strategic direction.

Completed Interviews (7 of 7)

Chrissy Oelke

Data Analytics/CRM • 30 years at Horicon Bank

March 2, 2026 • 30 minutes

View Findings

Kerry Murphy

Customer Relations • 19 years at Horicon Bank

March 2, 2026 • 30 minutes

View Findings

Danielle Schraufnagel

Marketing/Operations

March 4, 2026 • 30 minutes

View Findings

Natalie Kollin

Marketing

March 4, 2026 • 30 minutes

View Findings

Erik W.

Business Development Officer • 8 months at Horicon Bank

March 9, 2026 • 30 minutes

View Findings

Cassie Voight

Operations Officer VP • 23 years at Horicon Bank

March 20, 2026 • 30 minutes

View Findings

Rose Petitte

SVP, Director of Business Development (Kickoff)

February 18, 2026 • 30 minutes

View Findings

Upcoming Interviews

Stephanie Albers

TBD Role

March 23, 2026 • 12:30 PM ET

Note: Scheduling to be confirmed with Allison.

Key Insights Across All Interviews

→ Persona work remains in infancy; frontline teams do not use persona language or terminology

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→ "Together. Doing Good." has universal stakeholder support across all roles and markets

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→ Youth banking emerged as a priority from two independent interviews (Cassie, Natalie)

→ Marketing allocation (~$1.5-1.6M) needs restructuring from events-heavy to persona-driven strategy

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→ Total Expert performing well where deployed but internal adoption remains the bottleneck

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→ Dual-market challenge (established vs. Milwaukee) requires distinct playbooks and strategies

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→ Commercial/business persona is a critical gap flagged by both Operations and stakeholders

Chrissy Oelke Findings

Data Analytics/CRM • March 2, 2026

Data Analysis & Persona Validation

- Current personas match data segmentation for existing customers
- Wealthy achievers segment validated in data
- Iterating based on deposit generation vs. customer count
- December presentation was draft, excited for next-level development

Platform Capabilities & Gaps

- Total Expert journeys limited by technical constraints
- Data backend setup creates roadblocks
- Few journeys currently active
- Business onboarding journey in development
- Missing comprehensive customer journey mapping

Key Challenges Identified

- Gap between persona work and business goal alignment
- Need clarity on new acquisition vs. existing customer growth

- Milwaukee market (new) vs. established markets require different strategies
- Acquisition struggles confirmed by data
- Lacks consistent monitoring dashboard

Internal Communication Gap

- Data insights not shared with front-line staff
- Different market experiences create siloed perspectives
- Need transparency between data findings and employee observations
- Operating in "survival mode" vs. strategic approach

Kerry Murphy Findings

Customer Relations • March 2, 2026

Current Customer Service Reality

- 19 years at Horicon Bank, moved from frontline training to customer relations
- Frontline teams identify customers by demographics/life events, not personas
- "This person is buying a house" → ABC process
- "55 or better" → certain products
- Not using persona terminology at all

Customer Pain Points & Satisfaction

- **Unhappy customers:** Confused about new money transfer methods, online banking complexity, policy misunderstandings

- **Happy customers:** Love staff personality and community presence, seeing bank employees at local events
- Products "good enough" - competitive but not flashy
- Transaction volume down, but service complexity up

Geographic & Demographic Challenges

- **Dodge County:** Rural, simple lifestyle preferences, multi-generational values
- **Milwaukee expansion:** Different senior demographics, more diversity, requires different approach
- Mortgage strength not translating to market awareness
- "Best bank for mortgages" but not top-of-mind for home buyers

2026 Senior Market Focus

- Kerry's focus: Expand senior customers in Milwaukee County
- Events planned: Senior center symposiums, bingo sponsorship
- Exploring partnerships with assisted living facilities
- Considering dedicated "Golden Free Club" Facebook page

Danielle Schraufnagel Findings

Marketing/Operations • March 4, 2026

Total Expert Platform Capabilities

- Sending majority of marketing campaigns through Total Expert
- Building audiences within platform
- 3 customer onboarding journeys running (E-statement adoption)
- Listen for triggers automatically

- Retail staff actively using vs. business bankers

Journey Performance Metrics

- **Personal checking onboarding:** 6% failure rate, 50-60% open rates (8 months running)
- **Glider customers (55+):** Zero percent failure rate, higher open rates than standard checking
- **E-statement adoption:** 56% conversion rate (launched January)

Active Projects & Blockers

- Happy birthday automation defect - want to target specific customer group vs. entire platform
- Youth checking E-statement journey ready to launch - awaiting approval
- 3-year wish list includes commercial onboarding
- Analysis paralysis in meetings prevents execution

Key Operational Challenges

- Lack of clear strategic direction and prioritization
- Event-heavy focus without follow-up playbooks
- No systematic post-event nurturing
- Missing comprehensive campaign measurement
- No baseline performance tracking

Natalie Kollin Findings

Marketing • March 4, 2026

Campaign Capabilities & Strengths

- Strong toolkit for reaching personas: digital ads, events, email, social media
- Gliders (55+) persona performing well in campaigns
- Flourishing Families and Upwardly Mobile need performance improvement
- Multiple channels working effectively together

Digital Strategy Gap

- Website requires updates for younger demographics
- Mobile-first approach critical for attracting younger customers
- Digital presence doesn't reflect persona diversity
- Opportunity to modernize digital touchpoints

90-Day Strategic Pick

- If forced to choose one persona for intensive sprint: First-Time Workforce
- "Big life moment... a lot of growth there..."
- "If you start it young, you'll have them for a long time"
- Youth banking represents long-term customer value

Resource Constraints

- Time limitations are primary constraint, not tools or budget gaps
- Needs dedicated time to put plans together
- Consistency requires protected planning time
- Tools are sufficient but execution bandwidth is limited

Erik W. Findings

Business Development Officer • March 9, 2026

Milwaukee Market Reality

- 130-year-old bank with only 3 years in Milwaukee market
- Still explaining that branches exist locally
- Top-of-mind awareness not yet achieved
- Chamber of Commerce director providing warm leads
- Geographic expansion requires patient market building

Bank at Work Program Assessment

- Pilot initially struggled without incentive for business customers to promote
- Added cash bonuses - gaining traction with business partners
- Good concept but needs "wow factor" for differentiation
- Requires ongoing incentive structure to maintain momentum

Marketing Budget Allocation (~$1.5-1.6M)

- ~70% of budget allocated to events
- Radio in Milwaukee market has been cut
- No billboards in current strategy
- Digital ads lack geo-tracking capability
- "Impressions are fine but they don't mean anything. We need links that are clicked."

Brand Positioning in Business Development

- Uses "Together. Doing Good." far more than "The Natural Choice" in business pitches
- "That's actually one of my key taglines... it just really resonated."
- Business customers respond to values-based messaging
- Community commitment resonates across segments

Cassie Voight Findings

Operations Officer VP • March 20, 2026

Persona Assessment & Gaps

- Current personas are too similar with overlapping age ranges
- Missing commercial banking segments due to data source limitations
- "It just doesn't define anything" - persona clarity lacks
- Data constraints limit segment granularity
- Need for business banking persona explicitly identified

Internal Adoption Reality

- Personas known to senior management and some marketing staff
- Frontline and back office would not recognize persona language
- "Squirrel problem" with constantly changing priorities
- Lack of consistent communication across departments
- Strategy visibility decreases as it flows down organization

Total Expert Platform Adoption

- Low accountability for Total Expert adoption across organization
- Platform in place for years but real usage only in last 12-18 months

- Danielle Schraufnagel doing excellent work but broader adoption lags
- Retail staff using more than business bankers
- Potential for expanded deployment across teams

Youth Banking as Top Priority

- Top 90-day sprint recommendation: Youth Banking
- Personal motivation: "My 16-year-old daughter knows zero about banking"
- Young people getting financial knowledge from TikTok instead
- Greenlight is pulling money from traditional banking
- Created "My Money" checking with auto-age-18 transition
- Vision: Themed app with integrated financial literacy education

Operational Simplification Imperative

- "Keep it simple, stupid. We have to just simplify things and make it easier."
- Too many personas, too many priorities, too many names
- Simplicity as key to frontline adoption and execution
- Complexity is barrier to staff engagement

Rose Petitte Findings

SVP, Director of Business Development • February 18, 2026 (Kickoff)

Organizational Staffing Context

- Lost marketing manager Grace - created staffing gap
- Rose managing marketing directly alongside trust, business development, and data analytics
- Multiple portfolio responsibilities limiting marketing focus

- Resource constraints affecting strategic execution capacity

Market Penetration Challenge

- Limited penetration in SE Wisconsin/Milwaukee despite new branch locations
- "Build it and they will come" strategy has not worked
- Market awareness lag requires different growth approach
- Geographic expansion needs active engagement, not passive availability

Strategic Market Opportunities

- **Senior Market Expansion:** Minimal competition in SE Wisconsin for affluent seniors
- **Bank at Work:** Business customers without existing deposit relationships
- **Nonprofit Strategy:** Church/nonprofit partnerships (recent example: nonprofit brought ~$1M deposits)
- Board members of nonprofits are high net worth individuals
- Multiple entry points for market growth identified

Emerging Themes

Execution Gap

- Strategy and tech strong, frontline activation limited
- Personas known only to senior management
- Gap between data insights and customer-facing teams

Dual-Market Challenge

- Established markets vs. Milwaukee expansion require different approaches
- Customer expectations vary significantly by geography
- One playbook cannot serve both markets effectively

Technology Underutilization

- Total Expert showing strong performance where deployed
- Only 3 journeys currently active with potential for expansion
- Internal adoption is bottleneck, not platform capability

Simplification Imperative

- Too many personas, too many priorities, too many names
- "Squirrel problem" with constantly shifting focus
- Simplicity as key to adoption and execution

Values-Based Differentiation

- "Together. Doing Good." works across all markets and roles
- Community commitment resonates with business and consumer segments
- Connects to CHRE virtues, volunteer hours, local presence

Youth as Strategic Frontier

- Two independent stakeholders named youth banking as top priority
- "My Money" product already built; vision includes financial literacy app
- Greenlight identified as competitive threat in youth segment

- Long-term customer value if acquisition happens young

Cross-Interview Validation Matrix

Themes validated across stakeholder roles and departments. Checkmarks indicate independent confirmation of themes across multiple interviews.

Theme	Chrissy	Kerry	Danielle	Natalie	Erik	Cassi
Persona adoption gap	✓	✓	–	–	–	✓
TDG > Natural Choice	–	–	–	–	✓	✓
Youth banking priority	–	–	–	✓	–	✓
Budget restructuring needed	–	–	–	–	✓	–
Post-event follow-up gap	–	–	✓	–	–	–
Dual-market challenge	✓	✓	–	–	✓	–
Total Expert underutilization	✓	–	✓	–	–	✓

Validation Summary

Highest agreement: Persona adoption gap (4/7), Dual-market challenge (4/7), "Together. Doing Good." resonance (3/7)

Strongest emerging priority: Youth banking (2 independent senior roles)

Cross-functional insight: Technology platform working well, but organizational adoption is the constraint

Strategic implication: Winning strategy requires simplification + values clarification + market segmentation (not one-size-fits-all)